My Perfect Morning Routine

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 29, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/5tYfXW09kps Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter walks through his morning routine from a 4:30–5:30 AM wake-up to an ~11 AM second breakfast, prioritizing sleep tracking, early movement, sunlight, family, and protein-heavy eating.

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⏰ Wake-Up & Sleep Philosophy 0:00

- Wake-up time varies between **4:30 and 5:30 AM** depending on what time he went to sleep
  - The guiding principle is getting exactly **7 hours of sleep** — he identifies this as his personal optimal
  - Tracks sleep with an **Oura Ring** to determine and verify that optimum

💧 Morning Hydration Concoction 0:00

- First thing upon waking, he drinks a mixture prepared the night before
  - Contains **LMNT** (an electrolyte drink mix) — not sponsored
  - Mixed with **Ketone-IQ (ketone aid)** — also not sponsored
- Prepping it the night before removes morning friction and ensures immediate consumption

🚴 Desk Bike Cardio While Working 0:00

- Goes straight from drinking his morning concoction to a **desk bike**
  - Combines cardio with work — multitasking movement and productivity
  - Duration: **30 minutes to 1 hour**

☕ Espresso & Protein Drink 0:24

- Immediately after the desk bike session, he drinks a combination of:
  - **4 shots of espresso**
  - **2 bottles of protein** mixed together

🌅 Sunrise Ocean Walk 0:24

- As the sun is rising, he walks an **ocean path near his house**
  - Timed naturally with sunrise, suggesting a light/circadian rhythm benefit

👨‍👦 FaceTime with Son 0:24

- Around **7:30 AM**, he FaceTimes his son
  - Intentional family connection built into the routine each morning

🏋️ First Gym Workout 0:24

- After the FaceTime, he goes to the gym for his **first workout of the day**
  - Notably short session: approximately **20 minutes**
  - Framed as just the first workout, implying he may train again later in the day

🐟 First Meal: Sardines 0:48

- First food of the day eaten after the gym workout
  - **Two cans of sardines** — described with mild humor as "delicious"
  - Sardines did not sponsor the video
  - High-protein, nutrient-dense choice; consistent with a fitness-focused diet

🥩 Second Breakfast: Steak & Eggs 0:48

- Works for a few hours after sardines, then has a second meal
  - **Steak and eggs**, eaten around **11:00 AM**
  - Marks the official end of what he considers his "perfect morning routine"